Breaking up is hard to do

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/34677298.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

Category:
F/F, M/M

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Catra/Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora/Huntara (She-Ra), Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Huntara (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Past Relationship(s), Complicated Relationships, Established Relationship, Break Up Talk, Post-Break Up

Language:
English

Series:
Part 1 of In all kinds of universes

Stats:
Published: 2021-10-23 Words: 7,691 Chapters: 1/1

Breaking up is hard to do

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/34677298.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

Category:
F/F, M/M

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Catra/Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora/Huntara (She-Ra), Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Huntara (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Past Relationship(s), Complicated Relationships, Established Relationship, Break Up Talk, Post-Break Up

Language:
English

Series:
Part 1 of In all kinds of universes

Stats:
Published: 2021-10-23 Words: 7,691 Chapters: 1/1

Breaking up is hard to do

by the_Frank

Summary

Catra and Adora used to be together back in highschool. The break-up was rather messy but they managed to stay friends. And as long as they don't talk about their break-up, they're fine.

But perhaps they should do that. Because there is something strange about it...

Prologue

A street outside Etheria High, around 2005

Shocked, but alive and unharmed students began to emerge from the grand hall where the graduation was supposed to still be at full swing. Instead…

She looked around as the smoke coming out of Prime's crashed Pontiac increased, leading to more and more people shouting about 'fire', 'call 911' and 'fuuuuuuuuu…', Adora kneeled next to her best friend/crush that lay beaten on the street. A small string of blood ran from the edge of her mouth and nose, merging into a bigger string around her jaw. She was bruised and her dress was torn. But she was alive. They all were safe. And Prime was down a few blocks away, cuffed and being told his rights. They had won.

"A...Dora? Is it over?"

She nodded.

"Damn…"

Things had gone really messy once the street gang hit the party but she remembered something being said. Something she needed clearance of. Right now.

"Catra? Did...did you really mean it? Do you… do you love me?"

Catra opened her eyes again, coughed up some blood but still managed to look at Adora with a mix of annoyance and love.

"You are such an idiot…"

And then they kissed.

Actual story

Present day, 2019

I am , if I may say so, a pretty social person. Okay, I don't always know *just the thing* to say (That's Bow's area of expertise) but I am not one to be silent and frozen, not knowing what to say. Better be awkward than silent, you know? so when I stretched out my hand for another sip from my large cup of melted mocha latte it was not because I was nervous. The drink was a bit too sweet and definitely on the unhealthy side, but I had deserved this, dammit!

I was only going to meet Catra. That was all. Nothing special. Nothing at all. I glanced at my watch. It was 1:05 pm.

"Fashionably late again." I said to myself. Loud. Not weird at all. "How stereotypical," I added so people would understand I was annoyed and not being weird.

For all of Catra's skills, being punctual has never been one of them. And to make matters worse, I was already down two thirds of my drink. At this point, it was now more whipped cream than coffee. Almost undrinkable...unless you are Glimmer .

I decided to give *Pet rescue saga* a go but my hope for a distraction was d.o.a. I couldn't concentrate, all I saw was small cats. I put the phone back and began to stare around the room, searching for something to see... But nothing of interest showed up, since every Starbucks looks the same. More or less, but have you seen one, you've seen them all. There were the generic photos of happy people harvesting, the stupid quotes from people that tried to sound intelligent and a blueprint of a coffee grinder. I caught myself staring at them as if it was the first time I saw them. Like I, I dunno, didn't want to be caught sitting doing nothing. I took another sip from my cup, trying to look like *yes, I* am *supposed to eat all that whipped cream.*

I am an adult, god damn it! I can have coffee with lots of cream if I want to! And I am waiting for a friend! One of my best friends! In fact, my oldest friend! I am not having any uneasy feelings and I was NOT trying to drown them in sugar!

I put the now definitely empty cup down. Best friends… Yes, best friends! Even if the years had passed since the days at Etheria High, and I have met sooo many awesome people since, the BFS is still the BFS, you know?

Sure, it is mostly on Insta and telegram and not that much irl… (we moved to Ohio a few years back) but our private little message group is absolutely buzzing with activities. And I have conversations open with all of my friends! Bad science jokes, vegan recipes, Sea-hawks' shows… Perfuma is still the worst. Everytime she finds something new she floods our feed with auras and vibes and grooves. But it's actually cute and gives a feeling of… familiarity!

Okay, so there I got a message… okay, so let's see...

Huh. *Two* messages, one from Catra, and one from "SexyHotQuarterbackWife". Yes, yes, Huntara got to choose her nick herself and god bless her but she hasn't the best imagination. Not that she is wrong. She is hot. Really hot. And a quarterback. And my wife. For four years. And the mother of my kid. (Okay, not really, we used a donor. But she likes to say she knocked me up. She is like that and I let her have it.) Anyway, I opened Catra's first. I wanted to see the excuse. Had I had this tension in my shoulder all the time? I just felt it.

Went to the wrong damn coffee shop and sat there for ten fucking minutes. Be clearer on the address next time, dor-k! With you soon /C.

I put my phone down and absentmindedly began to massage my neck. Yes, absentmindedly, it took me a few minutes to realize I was doing that. So. Catra was coming. Now. Here.

I groaned at myself. Of course she was coming! Why shouldn't she! She is here on business but *she* called *me* and wanted to 'hang'. She was, IS my friend! Fudge, even if I don't see her as much as we used to, we still find time for each other! Just because I only went to New York to visit her twice doesn't mean we never see each other, like... Like… Like our wedding! Okay, bad example. Scorp and perfumas wedding? Okay, even worse... *Lonnie's and Kyle's and Rogelios* wedding then, goddammit!, where I had been one of the maids of honors *and* toastmaster along with her! Not to mention Kadrok's independence day, the wedding of Entrapdak (God, that was a doozy…) and endless B&Ws with Glimmer, Fuma, Mista, and us. Huntara never joins. She puts no limits on me but she just can't take that much bullshit, her words, and she means it in the most positive way. I think she will run for Senator when her career is over in ten years. Point is, we hang out, okay?

But never just her and me.

Okay, this is ridiculous! I have been meeting her by myself! Lot's of times! What about all the times when she visits Columbus? Always coffee at starbucks! Yes, all the seven times.

But Huntara *did* join us then. Twice. And Glimmer was with her once... Or Bow happened to walk by, I definitely did not text him and ask him to come and pretend it was accidental a few of those times as well... Or DT that time, but *that* was a surprise. Waaay to many innuendos. Never just her and me. Never.

Never…?

"Never. I've never been alone with her… Just her... have I?" I really need to stop talking to myself. "No. Not since… High school." Dammit! And I am NOT going to think about Highschool. Not going there. Nope.

I crossed my arms and looked sternly at the coffee grinder, my mind scanning through my memories for something, *anything* else, to think about… Yeah, nothing came up.

The tension from my shoulders began to spread, from my back all the way down to my stomach. I reached out for another sip, only to find that it had gone cold, leading to coughing fit after the bitter taste assaulted my tongue. I wish we had been in a bar. I would kill for a beer. I gave my growing belly a look and a pat. "There there, magical lesbian spawn. Mommy is not going to risk your life by having alcohol."

Great. Now people were staring. I had to appear like I couldn't be bothered so I took up my phone again and read the message from Huntara.

Hi sexxxxy! Bummer I ain't with you, I sure would rather been with you than at this damn boot camp. Sure, the game and the girls are as fun as always but these damn lecturers? They know football is a sport and not some academic crap, aight? They're so dry they would spontaneously catch fire if they didn't smell so much sweat! Even a training game they managed to turned into a drag. Don't think so much, feel the game, man! here's a few kisses and hugs, and even more for the little brat and a few more 💋 *on… you know where… Don't wanna lose you babe, not when your off to meet your ex without me. ;) XOXO, Huntara*

For a short moment, I felt warmed up by the message. Huntara... Blunt, and no English class could steer up her language… but even her bad grammar was endearing today. Buuuut she also managed to remind me of who Catra was. Because that was the deal, wasn't it? Not my friend. My ex. Not one of my best friends. Not an old friend from school. Not someone I had hung out with more than a hundred times… Catra had been reduced to my ex. It wasn't Taras fault, she just didn't think at times. But why was I so damn worried? It hadn't even been that much of a...Okay, it had.

It hadn't lasted for very long, just the one year following graduation, until I decided to be an exchange student in Uppsala. But boy had it been one heck of a crazy time. It was my first relationship and Catra's third. And the way up to it hadn't been easy either… We had a huge fallout in januari 2005, then we made up after the mess that was graduation and then it was us. Damn

all the emotions and hormones that came with the late teenage years! I wish my kid could be born a 25-year old… I suppose *that* would grant me a c-section.

Okay, so it was a little embarrassing but really it was just two teenagers trying to be more mature than they actually were. We were not *together* , we were having a *relationship* . Oh sweet Jesus what idiots we were… I was. Complete with a messy br… aaaand no, not thinking about that.

Not thinking about THAT. Besides, we made up once I returned from Sweden.

Buying her a fika did wonders.

We are friends.

Still, when Catra broke up with me… I... No, I am NOT going to think about that and I especially don't want *Catra* to talk about that! Oh man,why did I have to meet her just by myself? Why did this have to happen NOW!?

Speak of the devil..

"Hi Adora! Stop hiding in a corner! Still no haircut? Damn, you will lose your hair by 45 if you keep that ponytail! Can you look after my bag and I'll go get myself something? You want your usual? Blergh. Okay, BRB!"

And then she was gone from my line of vision as fast as she had appeared. ...Okay, not "gone" gone. She was at the counter, ordering. A Chai Latte Vanilla, soy milk and a tiiiny hint of cinnamon, and my usual, whatever that was. Catra has a history of being a very messy Coffee Shop worker and her speciality was to mess peoples orders up, including mine, even when we were dating AAAAND NO.

For some reason, my eyes went to Catra and I began to take in her appearance. Perhaps a bad idea but… That was where my eyes went okay?

The Barista was a pretty tall girl. Like, my height. Catra had started wearing high heels once she managed to learn to walk in them ("It makes me look hot and gives me a Babeintotalcontrolofherself-vibe. It's *not* an attempt to compensate, *Perfuma!*") but even so she had to look up to talk to her. She had always made it a thing that she was only second shortest and how she actually managed to get Glimmer on her hook (she is the shortest of the gang and HATES to be reminded off that, which Catra does ALL THE TIME.) She has changed quite a bit since highschool, I might add, which probably explains why she had the barista's full attention anyway. As she puts it herself, "a big fat round butt and boobs that makes people miss my eyes! Like that's something anyone would want!"

She's lying btw. She really wants every piece of her outfit to be noticed, which I was regrettably able to do in full detail.

She was, as she says, b.i.t.c.h.y to the nines. A dark purple skirt suit, white polo, black high heels, skin-coloured stockings and a red-isch scarf. It probably had a fancy name, which she had no idea what it was. That was Glimmer's responsibility, knowing colors and shit. Again, Catras words, not mine. But she always went with her choice so… Heh, I could even see a hint of visible pantyline which I knew was there on purpose. Not for me, but the glance she gave the guy behind her told me she knew perfectly well what he was doing. She lived for those moments. Her hair was as always, long and messy and yet stylish at the same time, however THAT was possible. I can barely get mine to look civil. Finally she was done and returned to the table. I hope she hadn't noticed how much I had been staring.

"That took fucking AGES! All looks, no brain in that one. Anyway, finally something *worth* drinking! And for you Dor, a double espresso macchiato, along with a little chocolaty treat for both of you!"

She paused and looked at me. "Adora. Black jeans and a yellow sweater? Boring casual as always. Geez. Be grateful you're already

taken, you wouldn't catch anyone in that outfit. I wouldn't have, had you worn that back then."

A smile. That glistering, perfectly white smile I knew I used to feel in my left pocket. I had to fight back the feeling of spitting out *The hell do you mean with boring CASUAL?* No, I wasn't going to ruin this. Instead I smiled back and began to talk. Neutral ground, safe subject. Work. Westerville South high was a good place, but the latest budget cuts had left me without a secondary trainer. I could manage, though. Probably. *You're hopeless. Lucky you're going on maternity leave, Burn-out would be your second name had it not been swordhand. (*What to say next…) The coffee machine in the teachers lounge was down again, which meant they had to buy their coffee at the café on the other side of the road and everyone with faith prayed it would be a month before it was fixed up *Ha ha ha! Figures! Teachers are starving for some joy in life! -Oh shut up! You'd live in a tank full of pumpkin spice chai if you could. -Guilty as charged, dor. So?*

A brief pause.

Huntara was so sorry she had to go to Baltimore on bootcamp. *She may be sorry she's not here, but she lives for her bootcamps, dor. -Yeah, I know. She's not herself when she can't work out. -Oh? Like another person I know? -Hush you. Just because I like to go to the gym doesn't mean… -'Likes to'? You're waaay beyond that when you go there six days a week, dor. - I like to stay in shape, ok? -Yeah yeah… let's pretend it's about that...*

Another pause.

They had finally got to fix up the bathroom and kitchen and they now had a bathtub large enough for two. *Cool! With jacuzzi? Those are the best! It totally revolutioned mine and Sparkle's sexlife! -TMI CATRA! -Psh. Like you haven't seen me naked, dor. - NOT THE POINT!*

I realized that I was probably working up a blush and I took a sip at my drink while I did my best not to look at Catra. I tried instead

to focus on what was written on that blueprint.

Fig A. Crowbar industries. Patent number… number… whatever.

I realised that Catra was giving me a queer eye. How long had I been silent really? So I blurted out, louder than necessary, "SO, HOW are YOU then?"

Catra looked surprised at the outburst, but her smile quickly returned before she spoke in a lazy, drawling stream of words.

Well, the business was as it always had been, *I won't bore you with boring shop shit, Dor. It's not like I get most of it anyway. We're doing good, and that's all I need to know. -Isn't it a vice president's job to run the company? -Nope. It's a reward for hard work. You don't have to know shit anymore, just look sternly at papers and say clichés at Ted talks. -I think yours was a good one. -oh? Checking me out online? What does the wife say, mmm? -CATRA!* She looked at the window shortly before continuing. The latest investment in Las Vegas has proven to be solid, and they were probably able to expand to Chicago or somewhere around there next year. Glimmer was Glimmer, always on the move. *You'd think a CEO would have more control of her time but nooo nooo. I had to get myself a boob job for my 32nd birthday just to make her look at me, yes I said it out loud, no reason to look shocked! -I wasn't s…*

Another pause. A long one. What to say what to say what to...

"Well, how are Lonnie and the horde?"

A safe Subject. Catra still gave me a long look but she answered. "I don't have that much contact with them nowadays, but I see their pictures online from time to time. They seem to be happy."

"Wasn't Lonnie playing in the Sea-Hawks band a few years back?"

"She still is, I assume."

“Oh yes… of course. But didn’t she step down to be with the family?”

“Well yeah, but they’re all taking a break. Sea-Hawk WAS pretty close to a burnout.”

“Mhm…Yes she was. Though, that’s hardly anything new for her. Always running herself into the ground.”

“How many kids do they have now again?”

Silence. Shit! Shit! kids! The ONE subject you don’t bring up to Catra! She and Glimmer have been trying for ages! And now I had…

It’s funny. How the mouth sometimes decides that since the brain is silent, it’s their job to take over. Even if the brain was just taking a moment to decide what to say. The mouth? Not so much. So I blurted out, “Are you and Glimmer thinking about kids? It takes longer than you think to get things arranged. This bad boy took us three years of prep! If you’re thinking of having children then you’d better be prepared to lose that rather fetching figure of yours. My body is pretty solid, but I take care of myself! Everyone says that you become a wreck when you have your first and Huntara is afraid she will get some mama fat once the kid is here.”

Catra stared at me. Shit. I just said that, didn’t I? But Catra blinked a few times and murmured.

“It’s… complicated. You...know how things are.”

I bit my lip, had I been able to, I would have eaten my foot. I am such an idiot! “Ah yes. I’m sorry Catra, please forget I said anything.”

“Nah. It’s okay.”

Silence. She looked at me, and when I didn’t say anything, she cleared her throat and spoke.

“If you don’t mind me saying, Adora, I think you should be careful once the brat is out. You say your body will be safe but I have seen sooo many bad examples. Those issues might lead to a big mess and end up in divorce. Just as it did with Mermista and Sea-hawk.”

Oh you didn’t just… not okay cat.

“I kind of do mind you saying, but yeah, I know. They’re still not on speaking terms, right?

“Nope. And both of them are on the rebound. Big time. Sea-Hawk is engaged now. To Bow. I know they have history and god bless the boy but I can't help thinking Sea-Hawk did it partly to hurt Mista. And MISTA… heh, poor sod. She was drowning herself with work until that new secretary showed up. Fuck, you must have seen how they have been showering Insta with cute couple pictures! It’s pretty ugly.”

“Yeah. Breakups usually are. Like ours.”

“What?”

Shit. Shit shit shit. Mouth, from this on you are not allowed to be in charge of talking.

“Oh I see. I see how it is.”

“Catra, I am…”

“Fuck you, Adora. So, that’s what it’s all about? Still so mad over our breakup that you take the cheapest fucking shot right were you KNOW it hurts! But please, let me tell you everything about our struggles! It’s just a joke to YOU anyway. It’s sooo funny how Glimmer is unable to carry since that car accident and It will be a laugh when we find out that my uterus didn’t survive that bar drawl from the day after graduation where SOMEONE could have been there to help me but OUPS! SHE WAS IN FANCY SCHMANSY SCHWEDEN BECAUSE SHE DIDN’T THINK I WAS WORTH BEING WITH! It's so funny, you know, to waste thousands of dollars only

to find out that you are USELESS, that sounds like fun doesn't it! ...I can't even give my wife the thing she wants the most. I am a waste of a human being… Funny, right?"

"Catra… Catra, please! I didn't mean to…"

"Of course you didn't. Jokes on me to think you would be mature enough to accept a break-up. I wasn't even being rude."

I stared at her. Okay, I had insulted her deeply but now she was dead wrong!

"YOU didn't… No no NO! YOUI did not break up with ME, -I- broke up with YOU!"

I rose from my chair and Catra did the same. I stared at her, and she stared back, she looked more angry now though.

"OH FUCK NO! *I* BROKE UP WITH *YOU* AND I KNOW THAT! Because that is the reason why I never want to be alone with you! The look on your face broke me and that is why this entire situation is as uncomfortable and itching as a pair of frilly underwear two sizes too small!"

I, and all the patrons in the coffee shop stared at the fiery girl's rather specific analogy, almost as if hoping for clarification.

"Don't. Ask. That's why I always have made sure that someone else is with us in case you should finally tell me that you...you…" Pause. "Di...did I say that out loud?"

"Yeah Catra. You did."

We stood in silence and stared at each other for a few seconds. Then Catra broke the silence.

"...I think it's safe to say that we both need something stronger. You still keep your little collection of liquor at your place? Especially those seventeen bottles of Scot Whiskey?"

"...Y-yes?"

"Good. I need a fucking drink and that now!"

A short walk, a three stop ride with the bus and another short walk later, we arrived at our apartment. The trip had been painfully silent, save the occasional "left next" and "watch the third step."

I walked over to the bar and took a bottle and a glass.

"On the rocks?"

"yes."

Quickly pouring the glass, I handed it to her. "There. Sorry I didn't have the 30."

"Just give me two glasses of 15 then." She smirked. A good sign, I hoped.

"Catra… Are you… did you mean it when you said you try to avoid being alone with me?"

She spun her glass for a few seconds, and spoke. "Yeah. I… It hurts, you know? Okay, so I really love Glimmer. Really. No offence, Adora but… It just wasn't meant to be us. But it still HURT, you know? And looking at you… It all comes back. Maybe I am more happy with glimmer. But you… You're my best friend. And I hurt you. I… didn't want that to happen again."

"Why would I… How?"

"The fuck should I know? Perfuma is the shrink!"

I swallowed. "Catra. I have felt exactly the same!"

"Really?" She said with genuine surprise, then she seemed to remember she was upset and added deadpan "really."

I wasn’t buying that of course. “Really! Catra, ever since you broke up with me… Yes. Huntara and I… It’s us. But to first almost lose you and then lose you again… It hurt more than I could bear back then. I am really really sorry I started to talk about kids. I can’t unsay it, but… I was just scared and… mad… I’m… I’m sorry."

Catra looked at me. She swallowed her drink in one go. Then she refilled her glass and swept that one too.Then she leaned forward and put her hand on mine with a determined face. “We are friends. We have been through hell together, the orphanage and all that jazz. May Sharon Weaver burn in hell. We have also seen each other sweaty and covered in mud naked. And we've been covered in petrol next to a burning car. I still love you as a friend. Please, talk to me.”

“I… I…” She sighed,and poured a new glass which she gave to me. “drink.”

“Catra! I am…”

“ONE glass. It’s not the first time people drink during pregnancy, knowing or unknowing. You need this. NOW.”

I took the glass, but I didn’t drink. After what felt like an eternity of embarrassing silence, I spoke up. “It’s all… It’s so silly. Now. I have been… So afraid. Of this. Of talking to you. Just you. And… Here I am. And I really don’t know why I was ever afraid to begin with.”

“Well, I am but a humble VP but…" She paused. " I'm not gonna assume anything. For me, it’s our break-up. Same for you?"

I nodded.

"Mkay… Would you please care to explain?”

I shook my head. I took a sip instead. It had been ages since I had a glass of whiskey. I wasn’t going to make it a habit but damn did it taste good. Catra sighed, and spoke. “Okay, if you’re not

talking, I suppose I have to. How you can’t remember, that is just insane to me, because I have it clear in my mind! It was some days after 'not-graduation' or whatever they called it… One year after Primes shit anyway. We were sitting under the stars. It was on that Goodbye-Adpora-Please-Don’t-Get-Kidnapped-in-Europe-Party Glimmer threw. And I… I loved you. Still does, deep down. But we had grown apart and even if I hated myself for thinking so, it was better to break up instead of keeping up something that would end in tears later. “

Catra took a moment to sip her drink, as if she needed help to remember that day.

“I had so many doubts. Was I doing this out of egoism or was I really doing what was best for both of us? Perhaps I was wrong. Perhaps we were meant to be? But then, why couldn’t I see a future when I looked at you? Why did... but… “

She looked at me. My face must have been completely blank. "You don’t… you don’t recall this at all?” I shook my head. “Huh. Here I sit making excuses for you and... And you say YOU broke up with me?” I nodded. “Really?” I nodded again. “Alright… so, how did *you* break up with me?”

I swallowed and put away my glass. I didn’t need it at the moment. In spite of how things started, the whole situation started to feel less embarrassing and more and more… friendly. Catra was my friend. A good friend that I could talk to about everything. I was still unsure of what to say. But I was no longer afraid to say it!

“I… I loved you, Catra. For real. But I was going away. And I was afraid. I trusted you, I did! But…” I sighed. “Maybe I was too much in love with the idea of love itself then I was with you. You… were my first real love. “

Catra blushed and looked at the floor. ”Yes. But that is water under the bridge now Dor. Now go on before we both fall asleep.”

"Ok. So, um, yeah. I... wasn't sure of myself. I think that was it. I told myself that it was because I doubted you but… in reality it was me all along." She paused. "Heh, I even rehearsed a script. It started like that. Kind off. 'It's not you, it's me'."

Catra immediately belched out her classic raspy laughter. "Adora!! Giving me the break-up equivalent of 'It was a dark and stormy night?' REALLY?"

I looked at her. Laughing? *Really* ? I wanted to give her a biting reply, but it didn't come. Okay, so 'It's not you, it's me' WAS lame. I rolled my eyes and smirked at Catra.

"Ha ha. Laugh all you want, but I thought it was a good start! I can't really recall the rest but it was something like, 'Not wanna hold you back', 'freedom' 'if you love them, set them free...' Etc."

Now Catra was laughing with her whole face. "Adora, just...Fuck me, that was the worst staple of cliches EVER! If you had said that, *I* would have broken up with you just because of lack of originality!"

Adora was giggling as well. "As if yours was any better! Stars, a moonlit sky? Who's the queen of stereotypes here?"

"Pot calling the kettle black? Well, then pot! Refill my glass and tell me how I SHOULD have done it!"

I made new drinks for us both (non alcoholic for myself this time. enough is enough.) and sat down. I was deep in thought for a while.

"Well... I would have sent you a text, asking to meet at a place where we would be alone, but not entirely. As an emergency exit, in case things went south? That...ice cream place near the cinema? And then I would do it simple but with style."

I went in with my best Catra-impression, which only served to make her chuckle more.

"Adora. I like you a shitload but things... have changed okay? And they will keep changing. And… Like, I can't see us in that. I'm setting you free, okay, Adora? You will always have a place in my heart, you damn idiot, but it will not be us two anymore.'" I paused and continued in my normal voice. "And then I would cry, you would give me a hug, pay for my ice cream and leave. And I would call Glimmer and cry my heart out."

Catra, no longer chuckling, walked over to me and gave me a hug.

"Adora PLEASE! I would NEVER leave you alone like that!" small pause. "Okay, maybe a small chance but… A-and it's good you never got to give me your speech," She added with gusto. "That WOULD have ended in tears."

I smiled. "So, how should I have done it then?"

"We-ell… You would have asked me over to your apartment, asked me to sit down, done a bit of small talk… then you would go…'I'm so sorry, Catra, being really long and cumbersome like you are.' And I would say, 'Why are you sorry?' and you would be 'Because I have something to say… and you won't like it.' 'Oh.' I would reply. 'So what is it?' 'I don't wanna say' you would say, 'but I need to' and then we'd go back and forth a bit and then you would blurt out, like you always do when you get to emotional 'I'm breaking up with you!' and then you would run out of the room crying and I would run after and find you on your bed and I would comfort you and dry your tears and kiss you and…"

"CATRA...keep it PG-13, ok?"

Catra placed a hand on her chest and stared at me.

"Adora! Do you really have that low opinion of me?" I was silent. "Okay, you may have a point, *usually* , but this time, no! I just wouldn't have left until you were asleep and then I would leave… and spend the rest of the night crying and eating ice cream. Maybe call Scorp in the morning."

I put my arm around my *friend* . “Um, eh, I’m not sure about that running out crying but, yeah… that’s pretty much me.”

“I know. You’re such an idiot, Adora.”

“I know.”

We sat in silence for a while. But now it was a good silence, the one you didn’t mind. Then it struck me “Catra? You said you broke up with me the night before you left? At the party?”

“Yes?”

“There… There never was a party that night."

Silence.

"Huh?"

"I remember now. I haven't… really thought about this before. But… yeah, that was the day. It must have … yes! Yes! Glimmer got sick the day of that party and…"

I paused. "And we simply decided to skip it.”

Catra blinked. “What? No no no, that can’t be! I have pictures!”

“Yes, but Glimmer threw two other parties that week! She did the “Adora’s-Going-to-Europe-Good-Luck-and-Come-Back-Soon” party first, around two weeks before not-graduation. Then the “Adora’s-Going-to-Europe-I’m-So-Sad-But-Happy-Too-Please-Send-Me-Swiss-Chocolate” party which was the day BEFORE not-graduation. There was supposed to be a third one, compensating for not-graduation ALSO being a mess, but then she got sick! And no one was really up for more cake so we just stayed at home and rested. Then you all sent me off at the airport. And I know it didn’t happen there, because Sea-Hawk filmed the whole thing!”

Catra stared blankly at me. Then she said slowly, “Dammit… you’re right! It never… But...But…Then…”

“Then you didn't break up with me. But since you had it all planned out and with there being two other parties… the memories probably got mixed up.”

Catra was silent again, deep in thought. She took a final sip of her drink, placed it on the table and looked up at me.

"Adora! Are you... sure... " Catra stared at me, then at the wall.

"I think I can call mom and ask her to dig up my old diary for confirmation, or text Entrapta if you want confirmation of the dates."

"You know what... I think I would prefer it if you did that."

A short message later, Entrapta simply confirmed that I had been right. Then we sat in silence again, Me with my phone in my hand, Catra with a drink in hers. Finally she spoke.

“Okay. So… I guess... It's hard when the memories are… And I could see it in my mind, it was so real. But it can't be real." A pause, and Catra took a sip, then looked at me. "I am sorry I asked you to... well, get evidence but..."

"Catra. Don't worry. I was going to look through my diaries for confirmation when I got home-home next time anyway. I am revisiting this as well."

"Yes. But still, I am sorry for doubting you." A brief pause. "But! Here's what’s so boggling about all this! I can’t remember *you* breaking up with *me* either! When was that?”

"Ehm...What does Perfuma and Scorpia do nowadays?"

"Don't try to dodge the question! Answer me, ‘SHE-RA’. When did you break up with me?"

I sighed. I had almost forgotten that stupid football nickname. *Eh, better get it out as well* , I swallowed and started to speak. Silent and slow at first, gaining volume and speed as I went on:

“It was the day of not-graduation. In the evening. I had it all practiced! We were gonna have the ceremony and then we were going out for coffee, tea and chocolate, and I was going to tell you afterwards. I had spent all night thinking about that and I had decided that I didn't want this to affect us hanging out with the girls, plus I didn't want you to ruin your makeup because you hate to cry in public and…”

I was silent and her face got a deep crimson red. “Oh shit."

"Adora, I *can* admit that I cry sometimes." Another short pause. "Mostly."

"Yes yes, but it's not that! You remember! Things got so emotional and messy and then Prime's brother came in with the watergun but we all thought it was real and Glimmer dropkicked him and… we never went out after, We never -we never had chocolate! We didn't have anything. We just went home. We…" I paused. "I don't need to look at my diary or ask Entrapta to remember what happened that day. And I..."

I looked up at Catra. “I didn’t break up with you either. None of us did.”

Once again a deep silence. “Adora…”

“Yes Catra?”

“Do you have enough booze to cover this?”

"Let me check."

***

Much much later, two exes… no -two friends!- were sitting in the kitchen. First we cried, then laughed, then we laughed and cried at the same time. Catra was getting slushed, and a pregnant mind is not far from being drunk. Then we (okay, Catra did) declared ourselves to be the masters of friendship and un-break-ups and then she had another drink.

After that, the evening had been more sketchy but I hadn't had that much fun in years. Catra fetched my old guitar and sang through a few of the love songs she had written for me. They were all very sincere and sooo cheesy making us both laughing our hair off. *If you'd finally get rid of that stupid hair poof, I would gladly loose mine in the process!* Then Catra shared a few of her love poems from back then.

"You really saved those?"

"When I turn 50 I will have enough money to pay for a career as a rock star. Then I need my lyrics."

Some she had shown me back then, but most of them she had never dared to show. Catra had dared to cross over into the x-rated area and… yes. Lets just say there was so much more laughing and once I pointed out "That's not what cervix means."

To which Catra replied, trying intensely not to spit out her drink. "Oh-h-h-h shit, Adora! Don't I know it! First time with Glimmer… when I asked her to… to...And she just looked at me and was like, 'Did you sleep through anatomy class or do you really want me to get the kitchen knife?'

More laughter, more cider. Then silence again. "I can't believe I have been such a fool through all these years."

"Well, kettle… I'm right here with you."

I looked at my *best friend,* and smiled. All the fear was gone. I was still a bit embarrassed, and when Mermista would hear about this… but still. I felt lighter and much happier than I had in years. And then my mouth spoke without me thinking. Again. bad mouth! I am grounding you!

"Does this mean that we're technically still together?"

"You mean like in that awful movie? About the girl who wanted to get married and wasn't divorced?"

“No! Or, um, sorta?”

“...In a way I guess, but not really, right?”

“Perhaps we should do it?”

“Adora. Free love and no limits and all that yes, but I AM married.”

I punched Catra on her shoulder. “Not THAT ‘It’! Break up I mean! As we, as we planned to do. Also, married woman here too, remember?”

Catra looked surprised, then she gave it some thought and finally she said, “You know what? I think we should!”

I cleared my throat. “Alright. Catra MeowMeow-Moon. I’m breaking up with you! AND I’m making it official on Facebook!”

I grabbed my phone and began to write, but then Catra smiled and put her arm on mine.

“Oh no. No no. We are not to be breaking up like adults. That just wont do after this -Adora. Ehrm. I want you to break up with me just exactly like you would have done it back then. I want my *teenage gee-eff* Adora to do it. Because she was the one that wanted to, and she should have the honors. And after that… *Teenage* Catra would do the same to *her* gee-eff. To put the past behind us 'for realsies' as Scorpia says.”

I shook my head, chuckling at Catra’s antics. However, I did excuse myself and went out into my study. It didn’t take long to get the note. I had actually told Catra a small lie. I *still* remembered most of my script and I *had* saved the note, though I can't really explain why.

Perhaps it was for this reason.

As I passed the hall, I searched my closet for another accessory that was totally necessary. Catra’s leather jacket. Now, it didn’t fit

as well as it used to but it was all about the atmosphere! And it wasn't as I was going to close it anyway.

When I entered, Catra clapped her hands, whistled and shouted "woop woop!" I bowed, produced the note and began.

"So...um...Catra… I…"

"Come on, Adora! Give momma a show to...OW!!"

I threw a pillow at Catra. "Stop! You're ruining the mood! So...Ehrm…

Catra. It's not you. It's me. We are going in different directions in life. I can't go where you go, I want to, but I can't. And I don't want to be the burden that keeps you from spreading your wings and flying away. You need your freedom, you deserve that freedom. They say, if you love them, let them go. And that's what I'm doing. Letting you go. Now. Right. now. Yeah."

Catra looked at me. And then, tears started to flow. I soon joined her, and we sat down next to each other to hug it out. Finally Catra broke the silence. "So...that… that was damn HEARTBREAK."

"I-I know…"

"But at the same time… it felt good."

"Yeah. Yeah it did."

"Do I need to break up with you?"

"Only if you want to."

"I would need that starry sky. And you can't see the stars in down town Columbus. To light."

"We could take a cab?"

"Hell no. I can't walk longer than the bathroom."

“Just do it here then.”

“Okay...Adora Greyskull...I...Oh crap. I can’t remember.”

“Just do it anyway.”

“So...It’s not you, it’s me…Oh for the love of… STOP LAUGHING!”

***

The morning after. I woke up in my own bed with the dreadful headache that comes from staying up too late when pregnant. I didn’t want to leave the warm bed buuut the toilet called so I had no choice. As I passed the living room, I found Catra still sleeping on the sofa, a small string of drool from her mouth. I smiled. She even made an awkward sleeping position after a drunk night in a middle class living room look rad.

Turning back to my intended task, I went to the bathroom, and after realizing I was way too awake to go back to bed, I went and made some coffee. It took an hour for Catra to wake up and crawl out to the kitchen. She mumbled, “Coffee”, got it, and drank. After that, she was more her usual self. As she rummaged through her bag 'for painkillers' she apparently got hold of something else. She looked at the small package asked, shrugged her shoulders and asked to use the bathroom. It took really long, time enough for me to make eggs-long. Which I did actually. When she returned, she was pale as a ghost.

I rose. “Catra! What’s wrong?”

She held something in her hand and now she presented it to me. “A… a pregnancy test?” I looked at it. “It’s… It’s POSITIVE?”

Catra stared at me. And then she smiled. “I’m going to be a mom.”And then she screamed. “I AM GOING TO BE A MOM!”

“Catra, that is so great! Call glimmer! right now! She…”

“Adora. She can wait. It’s… Okay, it’s big for us right. But I have to melt this myself first. I mean… You heard me. I didn't… I couldn't… I need some time." She grabbed my shoulders. "And I can’t think about a better way than to spend the day with my BEST FRIEND. Mrs. Greyskull-McLeod." Then she hugged me. "Not that I like you or anything”

I smiled. “Of course. I know. And It’s just Greyskull. Greyskull-McLeod sounds like a character from Braveheart.”

"Huh. It does. Good for you then! Meowmeow-Moon is a fucking mouthful of girlcum. Can we go to the park? After last night, I need some fresh air.”

“Catra! Really? And we still need to clean this mess.” okay, so the apartment wasn’t that untidy but...

“That sounds like a problem for future Adora and Catra. Park. Now. Calling cab. Now.” I shook my head and smiled.

In the cab on the way to the park, I felt very much in sync with the world. Things were good. “I bet the little bugger decided to crawl out after our row last night. That’s typical for a kid with me and sparkles as mothers. They can’t exist without drama! OH THE DRAMA!” I snickered, I had a reply on my lips, but then my phone started to buzz, A message from Huntara.

*What is this *changed relationship status*? BROKE UP WITH CATRA MOON? IS THERE SOMETHING I NEED TO KNOW?*

I laughed and pressed ‘call.’ As I waited for my wife to pick up, I chuckled to myself.

“Oh Babe...you don’t know the start of it.”

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!